

4.3 Unit 4, Topic A: EU Political Issues

Focus This topic examines the political issues that have arisen as a result of the process of European integration, and the impact of the EU on the UK. It also looks at European institutions and their inter-relationships and the European economic and social model.

What students need to learn: ***Students taking Unit 4, Topic A must learn all areas within the topic.***

Impact of the EU on the UK

Key concepts	Content explanation
national sovereignty qualified majority voting (QMV) national veto subsidiarity	■ A knowledge of the impact of the EU on UK policies and political parties, including changes in party attitudes towards the EU. ■ An awareness of the factors that have shaped these policies and debates about their impact and future development. ■ Effects on the constitution, on institutions and institutional relationships and on pressure group politics.

European Integration

Key concepts	Content explanation
Euro-federalism functionalism/ neofunctionalism pooled sovereignty subsidiarity transitional states	■ A knowledge of the process of European integration and of key treaties and phases in the integration process, including the issue of an EU constitution. ■ A knowledge of debates about the implications and benefits of integration, and of the relationship between integration and enlargement.

EU Institutions and Their Relationships

Key concepts	Content explanation
supranationalism intergovernmentalism democratic deficit accountability	■ A knowledge of the key institutions of the EU and of the relationship between and among them, including an awareness of the location of policy-making power within the EU and of the balance of power between the EU and member states and amongst member states. ■ A knowledge of the processes within the EU for ensuring democratic participation and accountability and of the success of the reform process.

Domestic Policy Issues

Key concepts	Content explanation
monetary union open economies labour markets, flexibility and mobility	■ A knowledge of the different economic and social models in EU states and the development of EU economic and social policies such as monetary union, the Common Agricultural Policy, tariffs and trade and those policies contained in the Social Chapter. ■ An awareness of the factors that have shaped these policies and of debates about their impact and future development.